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applications, except by explicitly declaring the permissions it needs for additional capabilities not provided by the basic sandbox. These permissions it requests can be handled by the operating in various ways, typically by automatically allowing or disallowing based on certificates or by prompting the user. The permissions required by an application are declared statically in that application, so they can be known up-front at install time and will not change after that.

Hardware supported

Supports ARM, MIPS, x86 and power architecture micro processor architectures. Has support for camera, GPS, compass, accelerometer, Bluetooth, EDGE, 3G and Wi-Fi. Has support for GSM, CDMA, EV-DO and UMTS.

Current devices using Android

Dell Mini3i, General Mobile DSTL1, Highscreen PP5420, HTC Dream (G1), HTC Magic, HTC Hero(G2), HTC Click, Huawei U8230, Lenovo OPhone, Motorola Heron, Motorola Sholes, Motorola Morrison, Philips V900, Qigi i6, Samsung I7500(Samsung Galaxy), Samsung InstinctQ, Samsung I5700, Sciphone Dream G2 and Sony Ericsson Xperia X3.

Final verdict

Because of the open source nature and the unique OS design, OHA's Android greatly improves the programming scope for developers. It provides at par or better user experience than most OSs out there. Most applications are fast, responsive and seamless. Web browsing experience is particularly good. Even though the software base is less right now, it certainly is the thing to watch for in the future. At least we will be watching!



OpenMoko FreeRunner Neo